

## TEXTBOOK ADOPTION

Textbook adoption shall be recommended by review committees appointed by the Superintendent or designee. State guidelines for adoption of textbooks and resources shall be followed. Resource recommendations of review committees shall be approved and submitted to the School Board by the Superintendent or designee.

A. Authority and Guidance. Loudoun County Public Schools' (LCPS's) textbook adoption process is implemented in accordance with the Virginia Department of Education's (VDOE's) [Guidelines for Local Textbook Approval](#).

B. Definitions.

1. Textbooks. The Code of Virginia defines textbooks as "print or electronic media for student use that serve as the primary curriculum basis for a grade-level subject or course." Subject to the above are the core subject areas of English/Language Arts, Mathematics, Science, and Social Science & Global Studies for courses in which VDOE provides standards. The adoption of textbook resources for other subject areas or courses and digital resources will be guided by similar processes, but may exercise abbreviated timelines and/or process steps. Therefore, for the purposes of this regulation and [Policy 5130](#), which it implements, "textbook" or "textbooks" includes primary textbooks and textbook resources (to include digital resources) for any instructional subject area.

C. Frequency and Alignment with Virginia Standards of Learning. Textbooks for each core subject area will undergo review at least once every seven (7) years, in alignment with VDOE's textbook review and approval schedule, and/or VDOE's revisions to the respective core subject area's Standards of Learning (SOLs).

D. Timeline. A typical textbook adoption cycle occurs over a semester and concludes at least a semester prior to implementation to allow for acquisitions, curriculum planning, and professional development for such textbooks.

E. Adoption of Textbook and Textbook Resources Approved by VDOE. LCPS may adopt any textbook that resides on a VDOE-approved list. For such textbooks LCPS does not need to conduct an independent local review, but may choose to do so, following whatever timeline and structure is determined appropriate by the content office and Superintendent's Designee. All textbook recommendations are subject to school board approval and adoption.

F. Adoption of Textbooks and Textbook Resources Not Approved by VDOE. LCPS may adopt textbooks not on a VDOE-approved list, as long as they have undergone a local adoption review and approval process for their respective subject area. Such local process includes components similar to the state-level review (to include a correlation with the SOLs for the particular subject area and a review of strengths and weaknesses

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in instructional planning and support). Additionally, such process requires the publisher of the textbook to certify the accuracy of the content of the textbook and sign an agreement to correct all factual and editing errors found in a textbook, at its expense, while also certifying that the textbook meets other requirements of the Code of Virginia related to textbooks. Such local process also requires that proposed textbooks and textbook resources be shared with and be subject to comment by the school community and public, at large, before the School Board's adoption thereof.

### G. LCPS's Local Textbook Review and Approval Process.

1. Request for Proposals Solicitation / Invitation to Participate. For all adoptions that meet the criteria established by the LCPS Procurement office (large scope and dollar amount), a Request for Proposals (RFP) solicitation, or an Invitation to Participate in the case of resources already approved by VDOE, shall be issued.

- a. Request for Proposals (RFP) / Solicitation document. The document is co-developed by the content office/textbook specialist and the Procurement office.
- b. RFP / Solicitation Function. The document sets forth the specific LCPS courses for which textbooks are sought and the criteria that will be used to evaluate responses and proposed textbooks. It further defines how and when publishers and vendors should respond to the RFP/Solicitation to be included in the consideration process.
- c. Additional Evaluation. The RFP/Solicitation outlines additional groups and criteria that will be used to further evaluate proposed textbooks (detailed below).
- d. RFP Distribution. The Procurement office notifies all known publishers and vendors, including any specifically brought forward by the review committee. Outside of an RFP, the content office, via the Textbook Specialist, invites all VDOE approved resources/providers to participate in the review process.

2. Administrative Steering Committee. An Administrative Steering Committee shall be formed by each respective Content Office for the subject area undergoing a textbook adoption review.

- a. Responsibilities. The Administrative Steering Committee is responsible for:

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- (i) Defining a timeline for the textbook adoption review process;
  - (ii) Seeking publishers/providers and specific resources from instructional staff to include in the process;
  - (iii) Establishing selection criteria, guided by a needs assessment or other input from instructional staff;
  - (iv) Ensuring the process is implemented in a confidential manner, where warranted, with fidelity, and without bias; and
  - (v) Conducting an initial review of proposals to eliminate non-contenders (i.e., those not aligned to the respective LCPS-issued Request for Proposals (RFP) / Solicitation.
- b. Members. At a minimum, the Administrative Steering Committee shall be composed of:
- (i) Content Office Supervisor;
  - (ii) Content Office Specialist(s);
  - (iii) Library Media Supervisor; and
  - (iv) Textbook & Digital Resource Specialist.
- c. The Administrative Steering Committee may include:
- (i) Directors;
  - (ii) Coordinators;
  - (iii) Facilitators; and/or
  - (iv) Additional subject area staff designated by the Content Office (e.g., those who oversee programs within the Content Office, specialized instructional staff, lead teachers, etc.).

3. Content Review Committee. The Content Review Committee is formed by the respective Content Office, which is also responsible for maintaining the Content Review Committee's fidelity throughout the textbook adoption review process.

- a. Responsibilities. The Content Review Committee is responsible for:

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- (i) Participating in a curriculum review and orientation;
- (ii) Reviewing and evaluating proposed textbooks against established criteria, including curricular standards; and
- (iii) Making recommendations for their adoption.

b. Members.

- (i) An invitation will be specifically extended to the Special Education Advisory Committee (SEAC), the Minority Student Achievement Advisory Committee (MSAAC), the Gifted Education Advisory Committee (GEAC), and the Loudoun Education Alliance of Families (LEAF) for a representative to serve on review committees.
- (ii) At a minimum, the Content Review Committee shall be generally composed of the following:
  - (a) Classroom teachers;
  - (b) School administrators;
  - (c) Parents and community members;
  - (d) Representatives from various regions of the County;
  - (e) Representatives from large and small schools; and
  - (f) Those who represent the diversity within our County.
  - (g) Those wishing to serve on the Content Review Committee may express interest in doing so or be recommended by others, while others may be invited by the Content Office. Not all who express interest may be able to participate due to committee size and balance constraints.

c. Size. Content Review Committees can vary in size and scope, depending on the subject area, number of relevant courses, and amount of overlap, if any, between courses and instructors. The

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aim should be to include 4-7 common content reviewers per course while meeting all other specifications herein.

- d. Confidentiality. Members of the Content Review Committee are confidential and known only to the Administrative Steering Committee and other reviewers. All members of the Content Review Committee must sign a confidentiality agreement, wherein they also certify there are no relevant conflicts of interest for such a process, before reviews begin.

4. Selection Criteria. The Content office shall set evaluation criteria and ensure inclusion of the following:

- a. Alignment with LCPS's mission and strategic goals;
- b. Alignment to Virginia SOLs, LCPS Curriculum, or other applicable standards; and
- c. Resources that are culturally responsive and free from bias.

5. Additional Review and Evaluation. Final recommendations for the adoption of textbooks are based on multiple factors, including, but not limited to, the content review. Resources are concurrently reviewed and evaluated as follows:

| Review Scope                                                                                                                                                                                | Reviewers                                                                                                                                                                        |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <u>School and community input</u> - Schools and their communities are invited to review finalist resources under consideration and submit comments to the review committee and school board | School staff and community members                                                                                                                                               |
| <u>Technical Reviews</u> - Proposals are submitted with the Technical Requirements document within the RFP completed                                                                        | Various central office staff may represent these interests: Network compatibility, safety & security, integration options, content redundancy, accessibility, and user interface |
| <u>Potential partners and cost</u>                                                                                                                                                          | Procurement                                                                                                                                                                      |

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6. Selection of Recommended Resources. The final selection of recommendations for textbook adoption is the responsibility of the respective Content Office and is based on the Content Review Committee's evaluation of selection criteria, as well as input from the additional review groups mentioned above.

7. School Board Adoption. The School Board is responsible for the adoption of textbooks and textbook resources. The Assistant Superintendent of Teaching & Learning (or designee) will share recommendations with the School Board as an Information Item, which also opens the public preview and comment window, which extends until the Action Item. Approximately one month after the information item, the School Board will adopt textbooks (or take other action) as an Action Item.

H. Community and Staff Notifications. LCPS staff and families will be notified via digital mass messaging (as determined by the LCPS Communications office) of the following events concerning the textbook adoption process:

- a. The issuance of an RFP and selection criteria;
- b. The formation of the Content Review Committee;
- c. Finalist resource reviews for school staff and community input;
- d. Recommendations to the School Board as relevant information items;
- e. The public preview of resources with an opportunity to comment;
  - (i) All comments should be reviewed and considered alongside Content Review Committee responses while being shared with the Assistant Superintendent, Teaching and Learning, and the School Board.
- f. Recommendations going before the School Board as relevant action items regarding the textbooks' adoption.
- g. Additionally, a comprehensive website, within LCPS's website, regarding textbooks and their adoption shall exist and be maintained with current information.

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Legal Ref: Va. Code §§ [22.1-238](#); [22.1-239](#); [22.1-241](#); [22.1-242](#)

Cross Ref: [Policy 5130](#), Textbook Adoption; Virginia Department of Education's [Guidelines for Local Textbook Approval](#) (approved Sept. 22, 2011)